

			Molecular Approaches to Clinical Microbiology in Africa 13-19 September 2025, MRC Unit, The Gambia						 MRC Unit The Gambia							
		Saturday 13 September	Sunday 14 September	Monday 15 September	Tuesday 16 September	Wednesday 17 September	Thursday 18 September	Friday 19 September								
PRECOURSE ON LMS - Bioinformatics 1: Introduction to Linux Bioinformatics 1: R Programming for Biologists		Transfer: 08:45	Transfer: 07:45	Transfer: 07:45	Transfer: 07:45	Transfer: 07:45	Transfer: 07:45	Transfer: 07:45								
	08:30	MLB 1st Floor (all day)	Lab safety induction MRC lab manager (MLB Ground Floor - Lab)	Molecular testing for TB (Gene Xpert) Lizma Streicher, Anzaan Dippenaar, Noutin Michodigni, Dam Khan, Estelle and Binta MLB Ground Floor - Lab	Multi-pathogen whole genome sequencing approaches using Oxford Nanopore Technologies Kanny Diallo, Simon Amoikon, Lizma, Anzaan, Noutin, Dam, Shola, Leonard, Estelle and Binta (ONT FAS present) MLB - 1st Floor then MLB Ground Floor Lab	Real-time multiplex PCR for amplification and simultaneous detection of multiple targets Dam Khan, Brenda Kwambana, Kanny Diallo, Simon Amoikon, Estelle and Binta (Ingaba Biotec FAS present) MLB 1st Floor then MLB Ground Floor Lab	Getting started with R: Setup and first data Leonard Ndwiga, Dam Khan, Shola Able-Thomas (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Data wrangling and transformation in R Leonard Ndwiga, Dam Khan, Shola Able-Thomas (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	08:30							
	08:45															
	09:00		Health and safety induction MRC Unit						Germs to genes Martin Maiden (MLB 1st Floor)						09:00	
	09:15															
	09:30	Registration													09:30	
	09:45														09:45	
	10:00								10:00							
	10:15								10:15							
	10:30	Welcome and introductions (Wellcome Connecting Science, training team, participants) (MLB 1st Floor)	Break (Tent)	Break (Tent)	Break (Tent)	Break (Tent)	Break (Tent)	Break (Tent)	Break (Tent)	10:30						
	10:45									10:45						
	11:00		Introduction to bioinformatics: Linux and BLAST Keith Jolley Simon Amoikon Shola Able-Thomas (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Targeted sequencing for detection of drug resistance in TB (Deeplex Myc-TB, Illumina) Lizma Streicher, Anzaan Dippenaar, Noutin Michodigni, Dam Khan, Estelle and Binta MLB Ground Floor - Lab	Multi-pathogen whole genome sequencing approaches using Oxford Nanopore Technologies Kanny Diallo, Simon Amoikon, Lizma, Anzaan, Noutin, Dam, Shola, Leonard, Estelle and Binta (ONT FAS present) MLB - Ground Floor Lab	Real-time multiplex PCR for amplification and simultaneous detection of multiple targets Dam Khan, Brenda Kwambana, Kanny Diallo, Simon Amoikon, Shola Thomas (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Exploring and cleaning data with R Leonard Ndwiga, Dam Khan, Shola Able-Thomas (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Data visualisation in R Leonard Ndwiga, Dam Khan, Shola Able-Thomas (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	11:00							
	11:15														11:15	
	11:30													11:30		
	11:45	Advanced Learning Skills (ALS) Wellcome Connecting Science											Comparing molecular and sequence data for TB Lizma Streicher, Anzaan Dippenaar, Noutin Michodigni (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	11:45		
	12:00							12:00								
	12:15							12:15								
	12:30							12:30								
	12:45									12:45						
	13:00									13:00						
	13:15	Lunch (Tent)	Lunch (Tent)	Lunch (Tent)	Lunch (Tent)	Lunch (Tent)	Lunch (Tent)	Lunch (Tent)	Action Planning and Wrap Up Wellcome Connecting Science (MLB 1st Floor)	13:15						
	13:30															13:30
	13:45															13:45
	14:00									Course Overview Brenda Kwambana, Martin Maiden	Molecular approaches for detecting encapsulated bacteria Dam Khan, Brenda Kwambana, Simon Amoikon, Shola Able-Thomas (MLB 1st Floor)	Introduction to Phylogenetics Martin Maiden, Keith Jolley, Simon Amoikon, Shola Able-Thomas (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Sequence typing with PubMLST Keith Jolley Simon Amoikon Kanny Diallo Shola Able-Thomas (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Biobank and sequencing facility tour (MLB 1st Floor)	Multi-pathogen whole genome sequence analysis Lizma, Anzaan, Noutin, Leonard, Kanny, Simon, Shola, Dam (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Lunch (Tent)
	14:15							14:15								
	14:30	Sample Management workshop Aaron Dean, MRC biobank team						14:30								
	14:45							14:45								
	15:00							Transport to Hotel	15:00							
	15:15								15:15							
	15:30	Break	Break		Break	Break	Break		15:30							
	15:45								15:45							
	16:00	Introduction to Genomic Technologies Abdul Karim Sesay	Interpretation of molecular tests for encapsulated bacteria Dam Khan, Brenda Kwambana, Shola Able-Thomas, Simon Amoikon (MLB 1st Floor)	Break		Germs, genes, and genomes Martin Maiden, Keith Jolley (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Fireside discussion Brenda Kwambana (MLB 1st Floor)	Multi-pathogen whole genome sequence analysis Lizma, Anzaan, Noutin, Leonard, Kanny, Simon, Shola, Dam (BRAY Lecture Theatre)	Key	16:00						
	16:15								Breaks/meals	16:15						
	16:30								Seminars, tours, discussions, workshops	16:30						
	16:45								Interactive sessions	16:45						
	17:00	Technology talks (Illumina, Oxford Nanopore Technologies)	Seminar Martin Antonio (MLB 1st Floor)						Lectures	17:00						
	17:15	Computational or analysis							17:15							
	17:30	Laboratory							17:30							
	17:45								17:45							
	18:00	Networking and dinner	Transport to Hotel	Transport to Hotel	Transport to local restaurant	Transport to Hotel	Dinner at the MRC	F001 - Main Building First Floor MLB - Molecular Biology Lab Building BRAY Lecture Theatre - Computation lab	18:00							
	18:15												18:15			
	18:30		Dinner at the hotel	Dinner at the hotel	Dinner at local restaurant	Dinner at the hotel			18:30							
	19:00												19:00			
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